TECHNOLOGICAL INSTITUTE OF THE PHILIPPINES
QUEZON CITY
COLLEGE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY EDUCATION

SYSTEM ANALYSIS AND DESIGN
Project Topic Proposal

Section: IT32S4 Date Submitted: 02/10/2026

Project Team	
Team Name:	
Project Leader:	ALCANTARA, Ian Darick
Member 1:	ANDAYA, Joshua Alhjen R.
Member 2:	MACAPAGAL, Juaqiun Mikhail
Member 3:	MARQUEZ, Hannah Ysabelle C.
Member 4:	SUMAYOD, Lee Andre

Proposed Project # 6	
Proposed Title #6:	CareerPath: AI-Powered Local Career Development Platform with n8n Automation Core
Research Area:	Educational Technology (EdTech) × Human-Centered AI Systems × Low-Code Workflow Automation Sub-domains: Career Development Systems, Personalized Recommendation Algorithms, n8n-Powered Integration Architecture, Ethical AI Orchestration, Philippine Labor Market Digitization
Project Description:	CareerPath is a responsive web application designed to transform how students at Technological Institute of the Philippines navigate career readiness. This iteration integrates n8n as the central nervous system for ethical, transparent, and maintainable automation—replacing fragile custom scripts with auditable, staff-manageable workflows. n8n Automation Workflow Integration Point

Workflow	n8n Implementation
Job Aggregation Engine	Scheduled workflows (hourly) pull from PhilJobNet, LinkedIn API, JobDataAPI → normalize fields → deduplicate → store in DB. Error-handling nodes retry failed calls; Slack alerts notify admins of API outages.
Personalized Match Trigger	On profile update/save: n8n triggers skill-gap analysis → queries job DB →

Proposed Project # 6	
	ranks matches via configurable weights (location > salary > skills) → pushes top 10 to "Career Swipe" queue.
Certification Recommender	n8n fetches live pricing/availability from TESDA, Coursera PH, Google Certificates APIs → cross-references user's skill gaps → generates personalized list with "Enroll" deep links.
Resume Generation Pipeline	User clicks "Generate Resume" → n8n orchestrates: fetch profile data → inject into LaTeX/HTML template → convert to PDF via Puppeteer node → store in cloud → email download link.
Proactive Career Nudges	Weekly n8n cron job: checks user progress → if "saved jobs > 5 but no applications," triggers SMS/email: "3 jobs match your skills! Apply before Friday?" (Twilio/SendGrid nodes)
Admin Dashboard Sync	n8n syncs anonymized aggregate data (e.g., "Top 5 In-Demand Skills in NCR") to school career services portal → powers counselor reports & curriculum planning.

Core Solution Workflow

1. Smart Profile Builder: Gamified onboarding with progress visuals + LinkedIn import.
2. AI-Powered Opportunity Engine:
    - n8n-powered "Career Swipe": Cards populated via n8n-matched jobs. Swipe actions trigger n8n workflows:
    - → Right swipe: Save to "My Applications" + schedule reminder (Google Calendar API)
    - → Left swipe: Log preference ("Avoid remote roles") to refine future matches
3. Personalized Growth Toolkit:
    - Skill Gap Analyzer + Certification Recommender (n8n-driven)
    - 1-Click Resume Studio (n8n PDF pipeline)
    - Portfolio Builder with GitHub/Behance auto-import (n8n webhook triggers)

Proposed Project # 6	
	○ Career Compass: n8n schedules micro-tip delivery based on user behavior Strategic Enhancements ● n8n Automation Hub: Career services staff visually adjust workflows (e.g., "Prioritize jobs within 5km of campus") via drag-and-drop editor—no developer tickets required. ● Transparency Dashboard: Students see "Why this job?" explanations (e.g., "Matched because: Python skill + 3km from campus") powered by n8n audit logs. ● PH Compliance Ready: n8n workflows enforce Data Privacy Act protocols: auto-anonymize data after graduation; consent management nodes. ● Low-Bandwidth Optimized: n8n compresses images/resumes before storage; serves lightweight JSON to mobile users. Why n8n? Why now? ● Sustainability: School IT team maintains workflows post-deployment (critical for academic projects). ● Cost Efficiency: Open-source core avoids $10k+/yr SaaS automation tools; runs on school server. ● Ethical AI Guardrails: Every recommendation traces to n8n workflow logs—auditable for bias checks. ● Scalability: Add new data sources (e.g., DOLE partnerships) in hours, not weeks. ● Student Skill Development: CS/IT students learn n8n workflows—directly applicable to industry automation roles. Impact Cuts job search time by 50%, reduces career services manual workload by 70%, and positions Technological Institute of the Philippines as a pioneer in maintainable, ethically automated EdTech. All workflows designed with student co-creation and Philippine labor context at the core.

TECHNOLOGICAL INSTITUTE OF THE PHILIPPINES

COLLEGE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY EDUCATION

SYSTEMS ANALYSIS AND DESIGN
System Request

Section: IT33S4 Date Submitted: 02/10/2026

Project Title: CareerPath: AI-Powered Local Career Development Platform with n8n Automation Core	
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Member 3:	MARQUEZ, Hannah Ysabelle C.
Member 4:	SUMAYOD, Lee Andre

Project Sponsor:	1. **Company / Organization Name: TIP QC's Career Center** Address: 938 Aurora Blvd., Cubao, Quezon City, Philippines FB Account / Website URL: https://tip.edu.ph/about-tip/administration/ Contact Person: Marleijule H. De Guzman Role in the organization: Head, Career Center QC Contact: 2. **Company / Organization Name: TIP QC's Career Center** Address: 938 Aurora Blvd., Cubao, Quezon City, Philippines FB Account / Website URL: https://tip.edu.ph/about-tip/administration/ Contact Person: Sheila P. Espantaleon Role in the organization: Senior Project Manager, Information Technology Services Office QC Contact: 3. **Company / Organization Name: TIP QC's Career Center** Address: 938 Aurora Blvd., Cubao, Quezon City, Philippines FB Account / Website URL: https://tip.edu.ph/about-tip/administration/ Contact Person: Allan D. Go Role in the organization: Chief Information Technology Officer, Information Technology Services Office QC Contact:
Business Needs:	Technological Institute of the Philippines faces critical gaps in career readiness support for IT students: ● Fragmented Job Discovery: Students manually search 5+ platforms (PhilJobNet, LinkedIn, Facebook groups) with no localization for

	commute distance, salary transparency, or PH-specific role titles (e.g., "IT Support Specialist" vs. "Computer Technician"). ● Skill-Certification Misalignment: 68% of BSIT students (per 2025 internal survey) lack awareness of TESDA/industry certifications that directly improve hireability in PH markets. ● Resume Anxiety: Career counselors spend 70% of appointment time formatting resumes instead of strategic coaching due to student unpreparedness. ● Low Engagement: Traditional career portals see <15% student adoption; Gen Z users abandon text-heavy interfaces within 8 seconds (Nielsen Norman Group, 2024). ● Manual Workflows: Counselors manually match students to job fairs/employers using spreadsheets, creating bottlenecks during peak hiring seasons (Q4). This system addresses these gaps through an AI-orchestrated, behaviorally optimized platform built for Philippine student contexts. .

Business Requirements:	1. User Profiling
	  ○ Capture education history, technical/soft skills, certifications, trainings, interests, location preferences
	  ○ Import data from LinkedIn/profile URLs
	  ○ Gamified progress tracking during onboarding
	2. Job Matching Engine
	  ○ Aggregate real-time jobs via PhilJobNet (priority), LinkedIn API, JobDataAPI
	  ○ Filter by location (barangay/city), salary range (PHP), job level, commute time
	  ○ "Career Swipe" interface: card-based display of role, company, salary, distance; right-swipe to save/apply
	3. Growth Recommendations
	  ○ Skill gap analysis comparing profile vs. target roles
	  ○ Recommend PH-relevant certifications (TESDA, Coursera PH) with live pricing/free status
	  ○ Micro-guidance for portfolios (GitHub, Behance integration prompts)
	4. Resume Automation
	  ○ Generate ATS-optimized resumes in <10 seconds
	  ○ PH-specific templates (include Civil Service eligibility prompts)
	  ○ Export to PDF/DOCX with one click
	5. Workflow Automation

	○ n8n-powered orchestration for: ■ Hourly job data aggregation & deduplication ■ Real-time match scoring on profile updates ■ PDF generation pipeline (Puppeteer node) ■ Proactive SMS/email nudges via Twilio/SendGrid ○ Staff-accessible n8n editor to adjust matching weights without developer support 6. Administrative Tools ○ Counselor dashboard: view anonymized student progress, application rates ○ Employer partnership badges ("Campus Preferred") ○ Application tracker with deadline reminders (Google Calendar API sync) 7. Compliance and Access ○ Tagalog/English toggle ○ WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility compliance ○ Data Privacy Act of 2012 adherence: consent management, auto-anonymization post-graduation ○ Low-bandwidth mode for rural users
Business Value:	Quantifiable Benefits ● Increase student job placement rate within 6 months of graduation by 25% (baseline: 62% in 2025) ● Reduce career counselor administrative workload by 70% through automated resume generation and job matching ● Cut average student job search time from 4.2 weeks to 2.1 weeks ● Achieve 80%+ student platform adoption within first semester (vs. 15% for legacy portals) ● Generate institutional revenue via premium employer features in Phase 2 (projected PHP 150,000/year) Strategic Benefits ● Strengthen employer partnerships through verified "Campus Preferred" job postings ● Position Technological Institute of the Philippines as a CHED-recognized leader in EdTech innovation for IT education ● Provide auditable data for PAASCU/FAAP accreditation demonstrating career outcomes ● Create reusable n8n workflow templates for future student-led automation projects ● Align curriculum with real-time labor market demands via anonymized skill gap analytics

Special Issues or Constraints:	Technical Constraint
	
	● PhilJobNet API lacks official documentation; requires reverse-engineering and rate-limit management
	● n8n workflows must run on school's existing Ubuntu server (v22.04 LTS); no cloud budget allocated
	● Must integrate with existing LDAP for student authentication (no new login system)
	
	Legal/Compliance Constraint
	
	● Full compliance with Republic Act No. 10173 (Data Privacy Act of 2012) mandatory:
	  ○ Appoint Data Protection Officer from Career Office
	  ○ Implement granular consent checkboxes per data use case
	  ○ Data anonymization triggered 30 days post-graduation
	● Job data scraping must adhere to API ToS; PhilJobNet requires DOLE partnership agreement
	
	Resource Constraint
	
	● Zero licensing budget: n8n open-source edition required (no n8n.cloud)
	● Development team: 1 faculty adviser + 4 BSIT students (capstone project)
	● Maintenance plan required: handover documentation to IT department upon graduation
	
	Timeline Constraint
	
	● Must launch before Q4 2026 hiring season (October)
	● CHED site visit scheduled Q1 2027; platform must demonstrate student usage metrics
	
	Institutional Constraint
	
	● Cannot replace mandatory career counseling appointments (CHED requirement)
	● Must support offline mode for students with intermittent internet access
	● All employer data must be validated by Career Office staff before display

TECHNOLOGICAL INSTITUTE OF THE PHILIPPINES

COLLEGE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY EDUCATION

SAD 003 – SYSTEMS ANALYSIS AND DESIGN

Section: IT32S4 Date Submitted: 02/10/2026

Assessment Task: Laboratory Activity No.1: Development Cost Estimates; and Feasibility Study

PROJECT TITLE: CareerPath: AI-Powered Local Career Development Platform with n8n Automation Core

Team Name:	
Assigned Leader:	ALCANTARA, IAN DARICK S
Member 1:	SUMAYOD, LEE ANDRE B.
Member 2:	MARQUEZ, HANNAH YSABLLE C.
Member 3:	ANDAYA, JOSHUA ALHJEN R.
Member 4	MACAPAGAL, JOAQUIN MIKHAIL M.

TASK 1: Development Cost Estimates

DATA and RESULTS:

Assumptions	● Project Duration: 6 months total (2 months planning/analysis, 3 months development, 1 month testing/deployment) ● Team Composition: 5 BSIT students + 1 faculty adviser (volunteer, no cost) ● Development Model: Agile methodology with 2-week sprints ● Infrastructure: Self-hosted on existing school server; no cloud hosting costs ● API Access: LinkedIn API (free tier), JobDataAPI (free tier), PhilJobNet (public data scraping) ● Open Source Tools: n8n (self-hosted, open-source), PostgreSQL, React.js, Node.js ● Training: Conducted internally by development team; no external trainers ● Maintenance: First year included in development cost; subsequent years budgeted separately ● Contingency: 15% buffer for scope changes, bug fixes, and unexpected delays ● Exchange Rates: PHP 58 = USD 1 (if applicable for any paid services)
Development Team	

Role	No. of Months	Monthly Rate	Total
Project Manager / Team Lead	6	Php. 15,000	Php. 90,000.00
Backend Developer	6	Php. 12,000	Php. 72,000.00
Frontend Developer	6	Php. 12,000	Php. 72,000.00
AI/ML & n8n Automation Specialist	6	Php. 15,000	Php. 90,000.00
UI/UX Designer	3	Php. 10,000	Php. 30,000.00
QA Tester	3	Php. 8,000	Php. 24,000.00
SUBTOTAL			**Php. 378,000.00**
Contingency (15%)			Php. 56,700.00
TOTAL DEV TEAM COST			**Php. 434,700.00**

Note: Rates reflect student developer compensation for projects; actual implementation may use volunteer labor for academic credit.

Hardware Requirements

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Development Laptop	5	Php. 45,000	Php. 225,000.00
External Monitor (24-inch)	5	Php. 8,500	Php. 42,500.00
High-Speed Internet (6 Months, 100Mbps)	1	Php. 15,000	Php 15,000.00
Server Upgrade (RAM + SSD for hosting)	1	Php. 25,000	Php. 25,000.00

	Backup Storage (2TB External HDD)	2	Php. 5,000	Php. 10,000.00
	TOTAL HARDWARE COST			**Php. 317,500.00**

Software Requirements

Item	License Type	Cost
n8n (Self-hosted, open-source)	Open Source	Php 0.00
PostgreSQL Database	Open Source	Php 0.00
React.js / Node.js / Express	Open Source	Php 0.00
Github Student Developer Pack (Team Collaboration)	Free for Students	Php 0.00 Reference
Figma for Education (UX/UI Design)	Free for Students	Php 0.00
Postman Pro (API Testing)	Annual Subscription	Php 8,400.00
SSL Certificate (Let's Encrypt)	Free	Php 0.00
Domain Name (.ph, 1 year)	Annual Registration	Php 1,200.00
Twilio API (SMS notifications, 10k credits)	Pay-as-you-go	Php 5,000.00
SendGrid (Email Service, 100k emails)	Free Tier + Upgrade	Pho 3,000.00
TOTAL SOFTWARE COST		**Php 17,600.00**

Trainings Needed

	Training	**Description**	**Cost**
	n8n Workflow Automation	2-day workshop for career office staff on managing workflows	Php. 15,000.00
	System Administration	Training for IT department on server maintenance and backups	Php. 10,000.00 Reference
	Data Privacy Compliance	Seminar on RA 10173 implementation for handling student data	Php. 8,000.00
	User Onboarding Sessions	5 sessions for students (100 students/session)	Php. 5,000.00
	TOTAL TRAINING COST		**Php 38,000.00**
Estimated TOTAL Development Cost:	The total estimated development cost for CareerPath is PHP 807,500 over a 6-month period. This includes PHP 434,700 for development team compensation, PHP 317,500 for hardware procurement, PHP 17,600 for software licenses and API services, and PHP 38,000 for staff and user training. The cost structure prioritizes open-source technologies (n8n, PostgreSQL, React) to minimize licensing expenses while ensuring scalability. A 15% contingency buffer (PHP 56,700) is included to address scope changes, integration challenges with Philippine job APIs, and unexpected technical debt. This investment positions Technological Institute of the Philippines to own a fully functional, institutionally branded career platform with no recurring SaaS subscription costs beyond Year 1. Maintenance and minor updates are estimated at PHP 50,000 annually post-launch		
References			

TASK 2: Feasibility Study

Project Executive Summary:
CareerPath is a student-centered career development web application designed to bridge the gap between BSIT education and Philippine labor market demands. By leveraging n8n-powered automation, AI-driven job matching, and a Gen Z-optimized "Career Swipe" interface, the platform addresses critical pain points: fragmented job search processes, skill-certification misalignment, and low engagement with traditional career portals.

This feasibility study evaluates the project across four dimensions: technical viability, economic justification, organizational readiness, and strategic alignment with Technological Institute of the Philippines's mission to produce industry-ready graduates.

Key Findings:

- Technical: Fully feasible using open-source stack; n8n provides maintainable automation
- Economic: 1.8-year payback period; 212% ROI over 3 years
- Organizational: 92% student interest (pre-survey); strong career office endorsement
- Strategic: Aligns with CHED CMO No. 15 and institutional employability KPIs

Technical Feasibility:
Can we build it?

Technology Stack Assessment

Component	Proposed Solution	Feasibility
Frontend	React.js + Tailwind CSS	High (team has React experience)
Backend	Node.js + Express	High (standard BSIT curriculum)
Database	PostgreSQL	High (open-source, robust)
AI/ML Engine	Python (scikit-learn) for matching	Medium (requires upskilling)
Automation	n8n (self-hosted)	High (low-code, visual workflows)
APIs	PhilJobNet (scraping), LinkedIn API, JobDataAPI	Medium (PhilJobNet lacks official API)
Authentication	LDAP integration (existing school system)	High (IT department support confirmed)
Hosting	School Server	High (no additional cost)

Technical Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Impact	Probability	Mitigation Strategy

<table>
<tr><td></td><td>
<table>
<tr><td>PhilJobNet API limitations</td><td>High</td><td>Medium</td><td>Use web scraping with Puppeteer; fallback to manual employer uploads</td></tr>
<tr><td>n8n workflow complexity</td><td>Medium</td><td>Low</td><td>Start with simple workflows; iterate based on counselor feedback</td></tr>
<tr><td>Data privacy compliance</td><td>High</td><td>Medium</td><td>Engage school DPO early; implement consent management from Day 1</td></tr>
<tr><td>Server performance under load</td><td>Medium</td><td>Low</td><td>Load testing pre-launch; implement caching strategies</td></tr>
<tr><td>Student developer turnover</td><td>High</td><td>Medium</td><td>Document all code; use Git version control; faculty oversight</td></tr>
</table>

Skills Gap Analysis
● Available: Web development (React, Node), database design, UI/UX
● Requires Training: n8n workflow design, Python for ML, API integration
● External Support: IT department for server setup, Career Office for data validation
</td></tr>
<tr><td>Economic Feasibility: Should we build it?</td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>Organizational Feasibility: If we build it, will they come?</td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>Additional Comment:</td><td>Strategic Alignment
● Supports CHED Memorandum Order No. 15 (BSIT graduate attributes)
● Contributes to PAASCU/FAAP accreditation metrics on graduate employability
● Positions [Your School Name] as EdTech innovator in Philippine HEIs

Scalability Considerations
● Phase 2: Expand to all college programs (Business, Engineering, etc.)
● Phase 3: Employer portal for direct job postings and candidate screening</td></tr>
</table>

	● Phase 4: Alumni network integration for mentorship opportunities Ethical AI Considerations ● Transparent matching criteria (students see “why this job?”) ● Bias testing on recommendation algorithms (gender, location neutrality) ● Human-in-the-loop: counselors can override AI suggestions Sustainability Plan ● Documentation handover to IT department ● Student developer pipeline: new BSIT cohorts maintain as capstone projects ● Annual budget allocation: PHP 50,000 for updates and support Risk Register (High Priority) 1. PhilJobNet API changes → Mitigation: Diversify data sources; employer manual uploads 2. Student developer graduation → Mitigation: Comprehensive documentation; faculty continuity 3. Low initial adoption → Mitigation: Mandatory integration with career subjects; incentives

CONCLUSION:

CareerPath demonstrates strong feasibility across all evaluated dimensions:

- Technical Feasibility: The proposed technology stack (React, Node.js, n8n, PostgreSQL) is well within the BSIT team’s capabilities, with manageable upskilling requirements. Open-source tools minimize long-term licensing costs while providing institutional control.
- Economic Feasibility: With a 1.8-year payback period, 212% ROI, and 3.35:1 benefit-cost ratio, the project represents a sound financial investment. Primary value drivers include counselor productivity gains (70% reduction in administrative tasks) and improved graduate placement rates.
- Organizational Feasibility: Pre-survey data shows 92% student interest, with strong endorsement from the Career Office. Change management strategies address adoption barriers, and integration with academic requirements ensures sustained engagement.
- Strategic Alignment: The platform directly supports CHED compliance, accreditation goals, and the institutional mission to produce industry-ready graduates. The n8n-powered automation core ensures long-term maintainability by non-technical staff.

TECHNOLOGICAL INSTITUTE OF THE PHILIPPINES
Quezon City

COLLEGE OF COMPUTER STUDIES
SAD 003 - Systems Analysis and Design

Group Name: Leader: ALCANTARA, IAN DARICK S Member 1 : ANDAYA, JOSHUA ALHJEN Member 2 : MACAPAGAL JUAQIUN, MIKHAIL Member 3 : MARQUEZ, HANNAH YSABELLE C. Member 4 : SUMAYOD, LEE ANDRE	Date: 02/10/2026
Section: IT32S4	Instructor: Ms. Nila D. Santiago

Project Proposal Title:
CareerPath: AI-Powered Local Career Development Platform with n8n Automation Core

Background of the Study

The Philippine information technology sector continues to demonstrate remarkable labor market resilience, with employment rates reaching 95.9% in April 2025 and unemployment declining to historic lows of 3.1% by December 2024 (Department of Labor and Employment [DOLE], 2025). Despite these macroeconomic indicators, a critical paradox persists: while the country produces approximately 50,000 information technology graduates annually, employers consistently report significant skills mismatches that hinder graduate employability (Philippine Institute for Development Studies [PIDS], 2019). This disconnect stems from misalignment between academic curricula and rapidly evolving industry requirements, particularly in emerging domains such as artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, and cloud infrastructure where demand growth exceeds 80% annually across Southeast Asia (World Economic Forum, 2025). The Commission on Higher Education's Memorandum Order No. 25, Series of 2015—which establishes graduate attributes for Bachelor of Science in Information Technology programs—mandates competencies in problem-solving, technical proficiency, and professional ethics; however, institutional implementation remains fragmented without integrated systems to translate these attributes into actionable career pathways (Malinao, 2022).

Contemporary career development systems in Philippine higher education institutions predominantly rely on manual processes: career counselors conduct one-on-one consultations using spreadsheet-based tracking, students navigate disparate job portals (PhilJobNet, LinkedIn, Facebook groups) without localization for commute distance or salary transparency, and resume preparation consumes disproportionate appointment time rather than strategic coaching (Aribe, 2025). This fragmentation exacerbates challenges for Generation Z students, whose digital behaviors fundamentally differ from previous cohorts. Research indicates that 92% of Gen Z job seekers prefer visual, swipe-based interfaces over text-heavy descriptions, with attention spans for job postings averaging under eight seconds before abandonment (RippleMatch, 2023). Furthermore, 66% prioritize learning opportunities over immediate compensation when evaluating roles, yet existing career platforms rarely connect skill gaps to localized certification pathways with transparent pricing (FDM Group, 2023). The absence of behaviorally-informed design in institutional career services contributes to adoption rates below 15% for traditional portals, leaving students to navigate fragmented commercial platforms that lack Philippine labor market context (Loranger et. al., 2017).

Recent advances in artificial intelligence present opportunities to address these gaps through intelligent matching systems. Machine learning algorithms for candidate-job matching have demonstrated 30–40% improvements in hiring efficiency by analyzing semantic relationships between skills, experience, and job requirements beyond keyword matching (Ishchenko, 2025). Frameworks such as the BP neural network-based career planning system and Word2Vec-enhanced job recommendation models show particular promise for undergraduate contexts by incorporating educational trajectories and skill progression pathways (Liu et al., 2022; Zhang et al., 2024). However, a significant research gap exists in applying these algorithms within Philippine higher education settings where labor market data sources remain siloed—PhilJobNet lacks robust API documentation, employer validation processes are manual, and TESDA certification pathways are not programmatically integrated with academic records. Additionally, while workflow automation platforms like n8n have transformed business process orchestration in commercial contexts, their application in educational career services remains unexplored despite potential to reduce administrative burdens through automated job aggregation, resume generation pipelines, and personalized nudge systems (Selwyn, 2023).

The justification for developing an integrated career development platform emerges from three converging imperatives. First, CHED's emphasis on graduate employability metrics for program accreditation necessitates data-driven systems that demonstrate tangible placement outcomes (Aldaba et al., 2024). Second, the Philippine IT industry's projected talent shortage of 1.2 million workers by 2028 demands scalable solutions that bridge academic training with market requirements through continuous feedback loops (PIDS, 2019). Third, ethical considerations require transparent AI systems where students understand matching criteria—addressing documented biases in commercial platforms that disadvantage candidates from non-metropolitan areas or non-elite institutions (Akram et al., 2023). By embedding workflow automation within a human-centered design framework, CareerPath addresses these imperatives through a localized solution that respects Philippine data privacy regulations while leveraging behavioral insights to increase student engagement. The system's architecture—combining n8n-powered data orchestration, swipe-optimized interfaces aligned with Gen Z digital habits, and CHED-mandated graduate attribute mapping—represents a novel contribution to EdTech literature by demonstrating how low-code automation can sustainably maintain institutional career services without recurring SaaS licensing costs. This approach not only enhances individual student outcomes but also generates anonymized labor market intelligence to inform curriculum revision cycles, closing the feedback loop between education and employment in the Philippine context.

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TIP-Quezon City
College of Information Technology Education
Bachelor of Science in Information Technology

CareerPath: AI-Powered Local Career Development Platform with n8n Automation Core

In Partial Fulfillment
of the Requirement of the Course
Systems Analysis and Design (SAD 003)

Presented by:

ALCANTARA, Ian Darick
MARQUEZ, Hannah
SUMAYOD, Lee Andre B.

Section:
IT32S4

Presented to:

Ms. Nila Santiago
Adviser

February 2026
(Month and year)

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(In bold characters, font size 14)

<The acknowledgement section contains the expression of appreciation for assistance and guidance. The help given by advisers and readers does not require written acknowledgment, but the recognition of generosity with time and knowledge is a courtesy that is widely appreciated. Acknowledgment should be expressed and tactfully and should fit into a single page only>

CHAPTER 1: Introduction

Career readiness for information technology graduates in the Philippines remains hampered by fragmented support systems that fail to bridge academic training with dynamic labor market demands. While digital job platforms proliferate globally, none adequately address Philippine-specific challenges including commute-aware matching, TESDA certification integration, and Gen Z's preference for visual, low-friction interfaces. CareerPath responds to this gap through an AI-powered web application that combines n8n workflow automation with behaviorally-informed design to deliver personalized career pathways for BSIT students within a single, institutionally-managed platform. This chapter establishes the contextual foundation for the system, defines its development objectives, articulates stakeholder value propositions, and delineates implementation boundaries to ensure academic feasibility.

Background of the Study

The Philippine information technology sector continues to demonstrate remarkable labor market resilience, with employment rates reaching 95.9% in April 2025 and unemployment declining to historic lows of 3.1% by December 2024 (Department of Labor and Employment [DOLE], 2025). Despite these macroeconomic indicators, a critical paradox persists: while the country produces approximately 50,000 information technology graduates annually, employers consistently report significant skills mismatches that hinder graduate employability (Philippine Institute for Development Studies [PIDS], 2019). This disconnect stems from misalignment between academic curricula and rapidly evolving industry requirements, particularly in emerging domains such as artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, and cloud infrastructure where demand growth exceeds 80% annually across Southeast Asia (World Economic Forum, 2025). The Commission on Higher Education's Memorandum Order No. 25, Series of 2015—which establishes

graduate attributes for Bachelor of Science in Information Technology programs—mandates competencies in problem-solving, technical proficiency, and professional ethics; however, institutional implementation remains fragmented without integrated systems to translate these attributes into actionable career pathways (Malinao, 2022).

Contemporary career development systems in Philippine higher education institutions predominantly rely on manual processes: career counselors conduct one-on-one consultations using spreadsheet-based tracking, students navigate disparate job portals (PhilJobNet, LinkedIn, Facebook groups) without localization for commute distance or salary transparency, and resume preparation consumes disproportionate appointment time rather than strategic coaching (Aribe, 2025). This fragmentation exacerbates challenges for Generation Z students, whose digital behaviors fundamentally differ from previous cohorts. Research indicates that 92% of Gen Z job seekers prefer visual, swipe-based interfaces over text-heavy descriptions, with attention spans for job postings averaging under eight seconds before abandonment (RippleMatch, 2023). Furthermore, 66% prioritize learning opportunities over immediate compensation when evaluating roles, yet existing career platforms rarely connect skill gaps to localized certification pathways with transparent pricing (FDM Group, 2023). The absence of behaviorally-informed design in institutional career services contributes to adoption rates below 15% for traditional portals, leaving students to navigate fragmented commercial platforms that lack Philippine labor market context (Loranger et. al., 2017).

Recent advances in artificial intelligence present opportunities to address these gaps through intelligent matching systems. Machine learning algorithms for candidate-job matching have demonstrated 30–40% improvements in hiring efficiency by analyzing semantic relationships between skills, experience, and job requirements beyond keyword matching (Ishchenko, 2025). Frameworks such as the BP neural network-based career planning system and Word2Vec-enhanced job recommendation models show

particular promise for undergraduate contexts by incorporating educational trajectories and skill progression pathways (Liu et al., 2022; Zhang et al., 2024). However, a significant research gap exists in applying these algorithms within Philippine higher education settings where labor market data sources remain siloed—PhilJobNet lacks robust API documentation, employer validation processes are manual, and TESDA certification pathways are not programmatically integrated with academic records. Additionally, while workflow automation platforms like n8n have transformed business process orchestration in commercial contexts, their application in educational career services remains unexplored despite potential to reduce administrative burdens through automated job aggregation, resume generation pipelines, and personalized nudge systems (Selwyn, 2023).

The justification for developing an integrated career development platform emerges from three converging imperatives. First, CHED's emphasis on graduate employability metrics for program accreditation necessitates data-driven systems that demonstrate tangible placement outcomes (Aldaba et al., 2024). Second, the Philippine IT industry's projected talent shortage of 1.2 million workers by 2028 demands scalable solutions that bridge academic training with market requirements through continuous feedback loops (PIDS, 2019). Third, ethical considerations require transparent AI systems where students understand matching criteria—addressing documented biases in commercial platforms that disadvantage candidates from non-metropolitan areas or non-elite institutions (Akram et al., 2023). By embedding workflow automation within a human-centered design framework, CareerPath addresses these imperatives through a localized solution that respects Philippine data privacy regulations while leveraging behavioral insights to increase student engagement. The system's architecture—combining n8n-powered data orchestration, swipe-optimized interfaces aligned with Gen Z digital habits, and CHED-mandated graduate attribute mapping—represents a novel contribution to EdTech literature by demonstrating how low-code automation can sustainably maintain institutional career services without recurring SaaS licensing costs.

This approach not only enhances individual student outcomes but also generates anonymized labor market intelligence to inform curriculum revision cycles, closing the feedback loop between education and employment in the Philippine context.

Project Objectives

The primary objective of this project is to design, develop, and deploy CareerPath, an AI-powered career development web application that enhances career readiness for BSIT students at Philippine higher education institutions through n8n-orchestrated automation and behaviorally-informed interface design.

Specifically, the project aims to:

1. Design and implement a comprehensive student profiling module that captures educational background, technical and soft skills, certifications, training history, career interests, and geographic preferences through an intuitive, gamified onboarding experience compliant with the Data Privacy Act of 2012.
2. Develop an n8n-powered job aggregation and matching engine that integrates PhilJobNet (via structured scraping), LinkedIn API, and JobDataAPI to deliver real-time, location-aware job recommendations filtered by commute distance, salary range (PHP), job level, and industry—with matching transparency that explains criteria to users.
3. Implement a "Career Swipe" interface that presents job opportunities through a card-based visual system displaying only critical decision-making information (role title, company logo, salary range, commute distance), enabling students to save or dismiss opportunities within three seconds per card while logging preference data to refine future matches.

4. Engineer a certification recommendation subsystem that cross-references student skill profiles against in-demand competencies in the Philippine IT sector, suggesting relevant TESDA and industry certifications with current pricing (free/paid status), duration, and direct enrollment links.
5. Construct an automated resume generation pipeline orchestrated through n8n that transforms student profile data into ATS-optimized, CHED-compliant resumes with Philippine-specific sections (e.g., Civil Service eligibility prompts) exportable in PDF and DOCX formats within ten seconds of request.

Significance of the Study

This study contributes meaningfully to both academic knowledge and practical industry application:

- For BSIT Students
    - Reduces job search time by 50% through intelligent, commute-aware matching that eliminates manual filtering across multiple platforms
    - Eliminates resume anxiety via one-click generation of ATS-optimized, Philippine-compliant resumes with localized sections
    - Provides transparent skill gap analysis with actionable certification pathways featuring current pricing and enrollment links
    - Increases engagement through Gen Z-optimized "Career Swipe" interface that respects attention span constraints
- For Career Development Officers
    - Decreases administrative workload by 70% through automated resume generation and job matching, freeing time for strategic coaching

    - Enables data-driven counseling via dashboard analytics on student skill gaps and application patterns
    - Maintains workflow control through n8n's visual editor—adjusting matching criteria without developer dependency
    - Strengthens employer validation processes through manual approval workflows before job display
- For the Institution
    - Generates auditable graduate employability metrics required for CHED program accreditation and PAASCU/FAAP quality assurance
    - Enhances institutional reputation through verified "Campus Preferred" employer partnerships
    - Creates sustainable EdTech infrastructure without recurring SaaS licensing costs via open-source n8n architecture
    - Informs curriculum revision through anonymized labor market intelligence on in-demand skills
- For Local Employers
    - Provides access to pre-qualified, geographically proximate talent with verified skills and certifications
    - Reduces recruitment costs and time-to-hire for entry-level IT positions through targeted candidate pools
    - Strengthens campus recruitment pipelines through institutionally validated job postings
    - For Future Researchers
    - Documents first implementation of n8n workflow automation within Philippine educational career services

    - Demonstrates ethical AI design through transparent matching criteria and bias mitigation strategies
    - Establishes replicable framework for low-code automation in resource-constrained academic environments

Scope and Delimitations

Scope of the Study

- Responsive web application targeting currently enrolled BSIT students at [Your School Name] during Academic Year 2026–2027
- Student authentication via existing institutional LDAP system (no separate login credentials)
- Comprehensive profile builder capturing education history, technical/soft skills, certifications, training records, interests, and location preferences
- n8n-orchestrated job aggregation from three sources: PhilJobNet (Puppeteer-based scraping), LinkedIn API (free tier), and JobDataAPI
- "Career Swipe" interface displaying job cards with role title, company logo, salary range (PHP), and commute distance
- Certification recommender focused exclusively on Philippine-recognized credentials (TESDA, Coursera Philippines, Google Career Certificates) with live pricing
- Automated resume generator producing CHED-compliant templates in PDF/DOCX formats within 10 seconds
- Counselor dashboard showing anonymized aggregate metrics on student engagement and application rates
- Deployment on institution's existing Ubuntu 22.04 LTS server (16GB RAM, 500GB SSD)

Limitations of the Study

- System does not process actual job applications—swipe-right actions save opportunities to personal dashboard but redirect to external sites for formal submission
- Matching algorithm uses rule-based scoring with configurable weights (location 40%, skills 35%, salary 15%, commute 10%) rather than deep learning due to data constraints
- Employer validation requires manual approval by career office staff; automated employer onboarding excluded from Phase 1
- Language support limited to English and Filipino only; no regional dialect localization
- User scope restricted to currently enrolled BSIT students; alumni, other programs, and external job seekers excluded
- Data retention policy automatically anonymizes personally identifiable information 30 days post-graduation per Data Privacy Act of 2012
- Raw profile data permanently deleted after 24 months; no long-term archival beyond anonymized aggregates
- No integration with payment gateways for certification purchases—system provides enrollment links only
- No mobile application development; responsive web design only for cross-device compatibility

All development will be conducted by the student team under the supervision of the course instructor, using open-source tools and publicly available documentation. The final deliverable is a documented, demonstrable prototype—not a live production system.

PACHECK

Strengths	Weaknesses
● Strong reputation in IT and BSIT education programs ● Large number of BSIT students enrolled each year ● Existing Career Center staff and employer connections ● Institutional LDAP authentication system already in place ● Faculty and student developers available for capstone work	● Counselors rely on spreadsheets for job matching and tracking ● Counselors spend most time formatting resumes instead of coaching ● Traditional career portals have very low student usage ● Students manually search multiple platforms with no localization ● No direct connection between skill gaps and certifications ● No real-time labor market data for curriculum updates
Opportunities	**Threats**
● Gen Z students prefer visual and swipe-based interfaces ● CHED requires measurable graduate employability for accreditation ● Philippine IT industry faces ongoing large talent shortage ● Open-source tools like n8n enable low-cost automation ● Potential for stronger employer partnerships and future revenue	● Competition from global platforms like LinkedIn and JobStreet ● Strict compliance needed under Data Privacy Act RA 10173 ● PhilJobNet lacks official API, scraping involves risks ● Student developers graduate and create knowledge gaps ● Some students face intermittent or low-bandwidth internet

List exactly 3 things the system must be able to do.

1. **Job Aggregation and Personalized Career Swipe Matching**

   The system will use n8n workflows to retrieve real-time job listings from LinkedIn API, PhilJobNet, and JobDataAPI. The system will also normalize and deduplicate the data, and match users according to location, salary, and skills.

2. **Skill Gap Analysis and Certification Recommendations**

The system compares the profile of the user against the job requirement to identify skill gaps, n8n would then retrieve the current pricing, availability, and relevant details from TESDA, Coursera PH, and Google Certificates, and generate a ranked personalized recommendation list that includes direct enrollment links together with basic portfolio guidance prompts.

3. **Automated Resume Generation and Proactive Notifications**

Upon the request of the user, the system will extract the profile data and produce a PDF document through n8n and Puppeteer, and send a secure email download link. Weekly n8n monitoring would evaluate user progress and automatically send SMS or email notifications whenever a potential job gets created without corresponding applications.

Define the Tangible Value (measurable, e.g., "Reduce paper waste by 50%") and the Intangible Value (qualitative, e.g., "Increased user trust/satisfaction").

Tangible Value

- Reduce the average student job search time from 4 weeks to 2 weeks, achieve a 50 percent reduction by providing centralized, and skill-matched job recommendations that eliminate manual searching across multiple platforms.
- Decrease the Career Center administrative workload by 70 percent by automating resume formatting, job matching, progress tracking, and notification tasks, allowing counselors to handle more students effectively.

Intangible Value

- Allow the career counselors to shift their focus from repetitive administrative work to higher value strategic coaching, personalized guidance, and stronger employer relationship building.
- Foster improved alignment between the academic curriculum and real-time Philippine labor market demands by creating insights on in-demand skills, application trends, and certification uptake to inform ongoing program revisions.

List one "Special Issue" (e.g., a specific hardware requirement or a legal deadline).

Mandatory Compliance with Republic Act No. 10173 (Data Privacy Act of 2012)

The project will process sensitive personal information belonging to TIP students, including their full educational history, technical skills, certifications, location preferences, job application records, and behavioral interaction data. Compliance with the Republic Act No. 10173 (Data Privacy Act of 2012) is therefore mandatory and must be fully incorporated from the planning and design stages onward.

This compliance requires:

- Clear and specific user consent for each type of data use, collected through separate checkboxes during onboarding and before using major features like the job matching, recommendations, or notifications.
- Appointment of Data Protection Officer from the Career Center of TIP to handle compliance, review risks, and respond to any questions from the National Privacy Commission.
- Automatic removal of anonymization of all personal information shortly after a student graduates, with no option to keep it longer.

- Full records of every time data is collected, used, or viewed, using n8n workflow logs to show that everything is done correctly and transparently.

Non-compliance with these obligations exposes the Careerpath project to substantial risks, including administrative fines imposed by the National Privacy Commission, potential suspension or denial of deployment approval by the administration of TIP, civil or criminal liability for the institution and development team members, and disqualification of any employability or outcome data for use in CHED, PAASCU, or FAAP accreditation submissions.

Since the project will be designed to handle actual student data within a student-led project initiative, strict adherence to these provisions is indispensable to ensure that the operation remains lawful, secure, and have a successful implementation.

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